

Title: What is an AED, and How Do You Use It? [Manual]

Excerpt:

During a medical emergency, knowledge of operating devices such as automated external defibrillators, or AEDs, are crucial to ensure survival. The concept is simple; using electricity to shock an irregular or non-beating heart in hopes of restoring cardiac rhythm and function. Take a look at this manual, so that YOU know the safe and proper way to administer aid with an AED.

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When a person is unconscious, not breathing, or has no pulse, extra life-saving procedures are needed to ensure a higher chance of survival. Unfortunately, it is impossible to determine the heart rhythm without a machine. That's where AEDs, or automated external defibrillators, come in: they analyze the heart rhythm and deliver electric shocks to restore a normal rhythm.

Before Starting:

Before using an AED, be sure to assess the safety of your surroundings and call 911. Make sure that you and the victim are safe before providing any help. Then, you would turn on the AED and follow the instructions from the voice prompt.

Step-by-Step Instructions:

1. Check that the scene is safe and whether the victim is breathing and has a pulse. Call 911 as soon as possible, you or a bystander.
2. Demand a bystander nearby to go get an AED. No time can be wasted. Begin CPR until the AED arrives.
3. When the AED arrives, turn on the prompt and follow the instructions. Remove clothes from the victim and make sure the chest area is dry.

4. For adults and teens, place one pad on the upper-right chest below the collarbone and one pad on the lower-left side beneath the armpit. For children under 8 years of age, place one pad on the center of the chest and one pad on their back.
5. As the AED is analyzing the heart rhythm, be certain that no one is touching the victim.
6. If a shock is advised, spread your arms out and yell "Clear!" to keep people away from the victim. Then, deliver the shock as prompted.
7. After the shock is delivered, keep initiating CPR until professional help arrives, or if the AED has further instructions.

Tips and Warnings:

When asking bystanders to call 911 or get an AED, it is never recommended to be vague. Every moment is critical when saving a life. Never say "Someone go get an AED!" or "Someone go call 911!", as the bystander effect may cause people to hesitate and delay help. Pointing someone out and instructing specific people to do certain tasks not only ensures a quick, rapid response but also guarantees assistance in urgent times.

Never be rash in helping others. During dangerous situations, both parties need to be in a safe area before any assistance can be provided. If both parties are hurt, survival chances are severely lowered.

Don't be afraid to be loud. Clearing the space for an AED is a vital step when saving a life, so don't be timid and speak with good volume to have people step away from the victim.